

STATE OF OKLAHOMA

2nd Session of the 60th Legislature (2026)

SENATE CONCURRENT
RESOLUTION 20

By: Pugh of the Senate

and

Kerbs of the House

AS INTRODUCED

A Concurrent Resolution congratulating the YMCA on 175 years of service; recognizing its role in strengthening communities; commending its staff and volunteers; and encouraging continued efforts to promote well-being and connection.

WHEREAS, the Young Men's Christian Association (YMCA) marks its 175th anniversary, having been founded in the United States by Thomas Valentine Sullivan in Boston on December 29, 1851, with a mission to put Christian principles into practice by building a healthy spirit, mind, and body for all; and

WHEREAS, the YMCA has continually adapted to meet the evolving needs of American communities, strengthening society by bringing people together, fostering relationships, and creating a sense of belonging; and

WHEREAS, the YMCA's legacy includes providing safe housing during the Industrial Revolution, pioneering the first night school

1 and English as a Second Language classes, inventing basketball, and
2 delivering the first group swim lessons; and

3 WHEREAS, the YMCA's legacy also includes establishing the Youth
4 and Government program, serving as the birthplace of Father's Day,
5 and becoming the nation's leading nonprofit provider of child care
6 and after-school programs to support working families; and

7 WHEREAS, today nearly 2,600 YMCAs serve more than 10,000
8 communities, with more than 300,000 staff and 350,000 volunteers
9 delivering essential programs to over 17 million people annually;
10 and

11 WHEREAS, the Oklahoma Alliance of YMCAs amplifies the work of
12 nine independent YMCAs through a shared commitment to strengthening
13 communities by connecting people to their potential, purpose, and
14 each other; and

15 WHEREAS, the YMCA of Greater Oklahoma City, founded in 1889 and
16 one of the earliest civic organizations formed after the Land Run,
17 was the first YMCA in Oklahoma; and

18 WHEREAS, Oklahoma YMCAs have more than 3,600 staff and nearly
19 7,000 volunteers providing essential programs and services to 37
20 communities; and

21 WHEREAS, the YMCA is a leader in aquatics (water safety and swim
22 lessons), child care, youth sports, meal programs, and health and
23 wellness initiatives, and is the largest provider of fitness
24 programs for older adults; and

1 WHEREAS, the YMCA creates welcoming spaces for people of all
2 ages, backgrounds, and abilities.

3 NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE 2ND SESSION
4 OF THE 60TH OKLAHOMA LEGISLATURE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES
5 CONCURRING THEREIN:

6 THAT the Oklahoma Legislature congratulates and expresses
7 appreciation to the YMCA for 175 years of service to the nation.

8 THAT the Oklahoma Legislature recognizes the YMCA's role in
9 responding to community needs, fostering relationships, and building
10 a sense of belonging.

11 THAT the Oklahoma Legislature commends the staff and volunteers
12 who create connected communities and advance the YMCA's mission.

13 THAT the Oklahoma Legislature encourages continued support for
14 the efforts to address social isolation and loneliness by creating
15 places that promote well-being and help people build relationships
16 and thrive.

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